Nov 11 training: "Inside Power Generation" run of show (draft 1)

Session: Wednesday, Nov 11, 2026, 1:30-2:30 PM, on Zoom. About 440 required and optional attendees, mostly internal; they need clarity, not engineering. Host: Stephan Hardt.

Promised in the invite: power-generation fundamentals and the market landscape, then a guided virtual tour of a 3D gas power campus (combined cycle, modular generation, BTM, LNG). The tour covers the major equipment and electrical systems, how they work together, and where wire and cable are used.

The rule for the next 19 days: if it doesn't serve one of the seven stops below, it goes in the parking lot (end of this file).

Slides: `renders/deck/training/SW-3X1_Nov11_training.pdf` (37 slides, built by `blender/deck_training.py`; JPG copies in `renders/deck/training/jpg/`): title, agenda; definitions and step back 3-5 (every power plant is this, four families, the mix today); market 6-11 (at a glance, load growth since 1996, turbine backlogs, the ~$1.2B cable prize, the project register, the state heat map); fundamentals 12-26 (open the box, a day on the grid, generator to light switch, cable 101, what a plant does to a cable, a modern gas plant, four ways to burn gas, what goes in and out, how an HRSG works, the voltage ladder, follow the power, same physics different owners, greenfield and brownfield, who buys and when, the campus with the LNG terminal); 7 tour-stop backup slides; the whole plant in one number, what the spec calls for, pain points and the answer, three things to remember + Q&A.

Rundown (60 min)

Time	Segment	On screen	Mins
1:30	0. Welcome and why this matters	1 title slide	2
1:32	1. Market and fundamentals	24 slides	28
2:00	2. The 3D tour: seven stops	Live viewer, plus one slide per stop if needed	18
2:18	3. Wire and cable takeaways	3 slides	6
2:24	4. Q&A	Viewer on the overview	6

Keep 2 minutes of slack inside the tour. If you run long, shorten stop 7 (LNG) to one minute.

---

0. Welcome (2 min)

Say: - "Every power plant runs on cable. Today we walk through a complete gas power campus, built as a 3D model with a full cable schedule, and look at what each part does and where our products go." - "No engineering background needed. At each stop you'll get three things: what it does, its electrical system, and the cable."

Housekeeping: questions in the chat, answered at the end. The recording will be shared.

---

1. Market and fundamentals (28 min, 24 slides)

Market slides 6-11 come from the Oct 6 PowerGen channel deck. **OEM, owner and EPC names are not on the slides; say them here if useful.** Verify the figures against the primary sources (appendix of the Oct 6 deck) before Nov 11.

Slide 3: Every power plant is this (1.5 min). The definitions: source (input: fuel or nature) → conversion (the black box: turbine and generator, engine, panel, fuel cell) → power (output: to the grid through a switchyard, or behind the meter). "Every plant fits this picture; what changes is the source and the machine in the box."

Slide 4: How electricity is made: four families (1.5 min). Thermal (heat spins a turbine: gas, coal, nuclear, biomass, geothermal, oil), water and wind (hydro, wind), direct (solar PV, fuel cells: no turbine, DC) and storage (batteries, pumped hydro: shifts power, does not make it). Firm vs variable. "Almost all of them spin a generator; every one of them ends in cable. Today: gas, inside the thermal family." Our campus has gas, engines, aeros and package boilers, the fuel-cell bank and the battery yard.

Slide 5: The mix today, and why gas (2 min). US electricity 2025 (EIA): gas 41%, nuclear 18%, coal 17%, wind 11%, solar ~7%, hydro 6%. Planned 2026 additions: 86 GW, mostly solar (43.4) and batteries (24), wind 11.8, gas 6.3. "Southwire cables every one of these. Today we zoom in on gas: it is firm, it is the backbone, and the next wave of data-centre load needs it."

Slide 6: At a glance (1.5 min). 378 GW in development (52 GW under construction), ~$1.2B core cable 2026-2035, 386 projects tracked, $50M+ booked in Q3. "Today's goal: know the plant, so you can follow the cable through it."

Slide 7: Load growth (2 min). 166 GW peak-load growth by 2030 (about 90 GW data centres); 378 GW gas in development (189 GW tied to data centres); 52 GW under construction; turbine lead times up to 7 years. The chart: the 2000-04 merchant boom built 188 GW (peak 57 GW in 2002); 2015-25 averaged 8.1 GW a year. "Today's pipeline needs a boom-scale build again."

Slide 8: Turbine backlogs (1 min). Turbine OEM 1 = GE Vernova (116 GW, firm backlog plus slot reservations, Q2 2026); OEM 2 = Siemens Energy (~69 GW gas-turbine backlog, Q3 FY26); OEM 3 = Mitsubishi Power (35 GW large-frame, Aug 2026). Tiles: +72% Caterpillar power-generation sales Q2 2026; 2.3 GW VoltaGrid modular fleet for Oracle's Texas AI data centres plus 1 GW for Vantage; 500 MW standard modular SGT-800 plant from Siemens Energy and Eaton.

Slide 9: The cable prize (2 min). 378 GW to 93.7 GW modeled additions to ~$180B of plant investment to $0.75-1.2B of wire and cable: under 1% of capex, on the critical path. By PO year: $673M named projects, $501M future allowance; peak 2028-29.

Slide 10: The register (1 min). 205.8 GW eligible; 68% only announced. Top states TX 55.5, LA 16.3, WV 13.4 GW (AZ is 6.1). Example owners if asked: NRG, CPV, Entergy, Homer City Redevelopment. Named EPCs: Kiewit/TIC, Zachry, Gemma, PCL, Burns & McDonnell; 87% of gross capacity has no confirmed constructor yet.

Slide 11: Where the build is (1 min). The state heat map: TX 55.5 GW leads, then LA, WV, IN, OH, PA. Owners: IPPs and behind-the-meter developers mostly build new; utilities reuse old sites (coal-site repowers 41.3 GW).

Slide 12: Open the box: the physical anatomy (1.5 min). Back to the black box, now for gas: the six steps from fuel infrastructure to end use, grouped under input, black box and output. "Same physics on every project; what changes is the machine in the box, and who owns it."

Slide 13: Four ways to burn gas for power (2 min). Simple cycle (the peaker), combined cycle (the workhorse, our power block), engines (the sprinter) and aeroderivatives (the jet): size, efficiency, start time, how they run. Units: GW, MW, kW; MW is power, MWh is energy.

Slide 14: A day on the grid (1.5 min). Illustrative 24-hour demand: baseload all day, solar at midday, combined cycle in the middle, peakers and batteries on the evening peak. "Every start cycles the plant and its cable."

Slide 15: What goes in, what comes out (2 min). Reuse boilers slide 6, "What goes in, what comes out". - In: gas, air, a little water. Out: power, stack gas, heat. - The gas turbines make about 2/3 of the power; the steam from their exhaust makes about 1/3 more with no extra fuel.

Slide 16: How an HRSG works (1.5 min). Reuse boilers slide 5: the "What it is" and "Fun facts" box.

Slide 17: From the generator to the light switch (1.5 min). Generator 13.8-25 kV → step-up to 115-765 kV → transmission → substation → 4-35 kV distribution → 480/240/120 V at the customer, with the cable family at each step. "Southwire has a product at every step."

Slide 18: The voltage ladder (2 min). Reused from the boiler deck (slide 9, "Levels, ratings and the cable they drive"): 230 kV to the grid, 21 kV at the generator, 13.8 kV to the big motors, 480 V to the small ones, 120 V AC / 125 V DC for controls, then signals. "Every rung has its own cable family."

Slide 19: Cable 101 (1.5 min). The eight families: HV, MV, LV power, VFD, control, instrumentation, fibre, grounding. By length in SW-3X1: instrumentation 44%, LV power 20%, control 18%, MV/HV 7%.

Slide 20: What a power plant does to a cable (1.5 min). Heat, cycling, electrical noise, hazardous areas, fire and smoke, outdoors, schedule, each with the answer (VFD-rated cable, ARMOR-X MC-HL, SIMpull, pre-terminated). "The wrong cable fails early, and a cable failure can trip a unit."

Slide 21: Follow the power (1.5 min). SW-3X1 cable by plant area, from the model's schedule: the black box (turbine hall, HRSGs, cooling, water) holds 44% of the 1,212 miles. The POI is where the plant meets the grid: plant side is owner and EPC scope, past it the utility's. "The grid connection carries the biggest cables; the power block carries the most."

Slide 22: Same physics, different owners (1.5 min). IPP = one company per plant + asset + power purchase agreement + customer + investors + market (ERCOT, PJM, MISO). Utilities and co-ops buy like utilities; hybrid IPPs both ways; pure IPPs are our sales focus for competitive thermal power.

Slide 23: Greenfield and brownfield (1.5 min). Five kinds of site from the register: greenfield grid-connected 77.0 GW, data-centre / behind-the-meter campus 54.5, coal-site repower 41.3, expansion at an operating plant 21.4, industrial captive and site reuse 11.6. New sites take the whole cable scope;

existing sites mean tie-ins, live equipment and outage windows. Plus work on running plants (HRSG module replacement: the boiler deck's outage story). Utilities mostly reuse old sites; IPPs and BTM developers mostly build new.

Slide 24: Who buys, and when (1.5 min). Develop → finance → engineer (the owner's engineer specifies the cable) → procure (the EPC or package builder buys it) → build (cable pulls on the critical path) → operate. "Be in the spec early; be ready when the EPC buys."

Slide 25: A modern gas plant (1 min). Six things beyond the power block, all in the model: private 5G monopole (massive-MIMO), EV charging and solar carport, the BTM data centre, LNG by sea, hydrogen, carbon capture, each with its own cable.

Slide 26: The campus at a glance (2 min). The campus aerial with the LNG terminal and the seven stops. - "This is SW-3X1, a 3x1 combined-cycle plant: three gas turbines, three HRSGs and one steam turbine, with a modular generation yard, a battery yard, a behind-the-meter data centre, LNG supply, and options for carbon capture and hydrogen." - "Conceptual and not engineered, but sized like real plants."

---

2. The 3D tour: seven stops (18 min, about 3 min each; stop 7 is 1 min)

How to run it: open the viewer and press **▶ Nov 11** (top left of the 3D window). It goes full screen with captions (Equipment / System / Cable). Use **→ / space** for the next view, ← to go back, keys **1-7** (or the chapter bar at the top) to jump to a stop, and **Esc** to leave. The tour has 22 views: an opening, 20 across the seven stops, and a closing cable X-ray. Use the same three beats at every stop:

1. **What it does** (1 min)
2. **Electrical system** (1 min)
3. **Where the cable goes** (1-2 min, show the cable X-ray)

Stop 1: Grid connection and switchyard

- **Does:** sends the plant's power to the 230 kV grid.
- **Electrical:** generator step-up transformers (GSUs) take 21 kV up to 230 kV; then breakers, disconnects, and a control house with protection relays.
- **Cable:**
- HV conductor and 230 kV cable;
- control and relay cable from every breaker to the control house;
- fibre;
- a buried ground grid (bare copper).
- **Line:** "Every breaker out here has a bundle of control cable running back to the control house."

Stop 2: Turbine hall: gas turbines, generators, steam turbine

- **Does:** three H-class gas turbines and one steam turbine turn generators.
- **Electrical:**
- isolated-phase bus from the generators to the GSUs;
- unit auxiliary transformers feed the 13.8 kV switchgear in R1;
- static starters spin the gas turbines up.

- **Cable:**
- MV-105 to big motors and transformers;
- TC-ER power and control to the lube-oil and hydraulic skids;
- thousands of instrument pairs (vibration, temperatures).
- **Show:** the R1 switchgear room interior (13.8 kV lineups, MCCs).

Stop 3: HRSG and its e-house (the boiler story; your best material)

- **Does:** turns exhaust heat into steam; the SCR inside cuts NOx.
- **Electrical:**
- the 13.8 kV feed pumps (two of 5 MW each);
- the T-R2A transformer feeds the e-house (480 V switchgear, MCCs, drives, DCS);
- CEMS shelter at the stack.
- **Cable:**
- one HRSG train is **707 cables, about 157,000 ft**, and **about 74 % of them are instrument and thermocouple pairs**;
- ARMOR-X MC-HL at the duct-burner gas skid.
- **Show:**
- the HRSG close-up;
- the e-house cutaway with its 9 callouts;
- the CEMS shelter (boilers slides 7, 9 and 10). Pick **one** of the three if time is short.
- **Close the stop on Boiler Row** (the last view of stop 3; boilers slide 4): the package, utility and electric boilers side by side.
- **Line:** "Three boilers, three cable stories. The package boiler is control cable, the utility boiler is instrument cable, and the electric boiler is MV cable."

Stop 4: Cooling and water: air-cooled condenser and water treatment

- **Does:** the ACC turns spent steam back into water. 80 fans, no cooling-tower water.
- **Electrical:** the R4 e-house holds four VFD lineups that drive the 80 fan motors.
- **Cable:** VFD-rated cable (ARMOR-X MC-HL VFD / TC-ER VFD) to every fan; water-treatment MCCs.
- **Line:** "Variable-frequency drives mean VFD-rated cable; ordinary cable fails early here."

Stop 5: Modular generation yard

- **Does:** fast-start, flexible power.
- **What's there:**
- reciprocating engine gensets in halls;
- aeroderivative simple-cycle units;
- two package types side by side: a factory-modular aeroderivative (AX-1, LM2500XPRESS class, ~35 MW, shipped as pre-built modules with plug-in interconnects) and an industrial gas-turbine package (IG-1, Titan 250 class, ~23 MW, one skid);
- fuel-cell and microturbine modules;
- the battery storage yard next door.
- **Electrical:** each unit has its own generator step-up and MV e-house; inverters and power-conversion skids for the battery and fuel cells.

- **Cable:**
- MV collection cable;
- DC cable at the battery and fuel cells;
- prefabricated cable spines installed as modules;
- skid pre-wire.
- **Line:** "Modular means factory pre-wiring, which is our opportunity to sell pre-terminated and cut-to-length cable."

Stop 6: Behind-the-meter data centre

- **Does:** a ~120 MW data-centre campus powered directly by the plant's modular gensets, with the grid only as backup.
- **Electrical:**
- 13.8 kV to 34.5 kV step-up transformers (3 x 90 MVA);
- double-bus 34.5 kV switchgear;
- a 40 MW / 80 MWh battery to absorb load steps;
- two data halls, each fed 2N through 48 pad-mount transformers and UPS skids.
- **Cable:**
- 35 kV MV cable;
- large LV feeders to the UPS skids;
- fibre everywhere.
- **Line:** "Data centres are why gas is growing again, and they're cable-dense on both A and B sides."

Stop 7: Fuel: gas yard and LNG

- **Does:** brings fuel in and conditions it: the gas metering and regulating (M&R) station, plus an LNG satellite of 8 tanks holding about 414,000 gal (about 3 hours of the whole plant) for backup.
- **Electrical:** an LNG e-house (13.8 kV / 480 V); pumps, vaporizers and the boil-off compressor.
- **Cable:** this is hazardous-area territory, so ARMOR-X MC-HL (Class I Div 1 and 2) and TC-ER control, PLTC instrumentation and fire alarm on one strut rack.
- **Line:** "Wherever there's gas, the cable has to be rated for it."

---

3. Wire and cable takeaways (6 min, 3 slides)

Slide A: The whole plant in one number (3 min) - The model's cable schedule: **6,011 runs, 21,217 cables, about 6.4 million ft (~1,200 miles).** - By footage: - instrumentation, 2.8 M ft; - 600 V power, 1.3 M ft; - control, 1.1 M ft; - MV, about 0.4 M ft. - Message: "Most of the footage is small cable: instrument and control. MV is the high-value part, but it isn't the volume."

Slide B: Product map (3 min). Reuse boilers slide 13, "What the spec calls for", or the brochure product map: - MV-105; - TC-ER; - ARMOR-X MC-HL; - instrumentation and thermocouple extension; - SIMpull THHN; - fibre and fire alarm.

Slide C: Pain points and our answer (3 min). Reuse boilers slide 14.

Close with three things to remember: 1. Gas plants are growing again, driven by data centres and firm power. 2. Most of a plant's cable is instrument and control; the big MV and power cable is the smaller share. 3. Southwire covers the whole plant: one supplier, staged on SIMpull reels, spec-compliant from MV down to the thermocouple.

---

4. Q&A (6 min)

Questions to prepare for: - "How long does a plant take to build?" 3-4 years for a combined-cycle plant; modular units are much faster. - "Who are the customers?" Utilities, independent power producers, EPCs, boiler and turbine OEMs, and data-centre developers. - "Is the model a real plant?" Conceptual, sized from public filings of real plants, and not engineered. - "What about hydrogen and carbon capture?" Both are in the model as options; show them if asked (layers on).

Backup plan

- **Recorded video of the tour:** screen-record the viewer stop by stop by Nov 3. If the viewer lags on Zoom, play the video and narrate over it.
- **PDF of all slides,** in case screen sharing fails.
- **Second laptop or phone** logged in as co-host.

Checklist

Date	Task
Oct 24-27	React to this draft; mark what to cut or keep. Tour mode done (▶ Nov 11 in the viewer); walk it once and note any view to change.
Oct 28-31	One slide per stop (reuse zone and boiler slides). Optional: modular turbine packages, **only if done in one day**.
Nov 2-3	Full-quality render batch overnight (renders/RENDER_QUEUE.md); record the backup video.
Nov 4	**Dry run with one colleague, timed.**
Nov 5-9	Fixes only.
Nov 10	Zoom tech check; freeze.

Parking lot (after Nov 11)

- Modular yard and Boiler Row are **closed for Nov 11** (Oct 24): no more equipment, fixes only.
- Possible later plant types: a CHP / cogeneration unit (gas turbine + HRSG selling steam to an industrial host), linear generators.
- Wastewater-treatment and cooling-tower refinements.
- Turbine close-ups at HRSG depth.
- More switchgear-room detail.
- Blender fly-through animation.

- Zone 07 parts 3-4 (construction compound, deck slide).
- Modular gas-turbine packages: done Oct 24 (AX-1 LM2500XPRESS class, IG-1 Titan 250 class). A larger SGT-800-class unit was tried and removed: it repeated the SC-1 / SC-2 simple-cycle story.